Dreamscope

COGNIVALAB COHORT · 5 NOVEMBER 2026

Reading the intangibles

What an AI that reads every answer finds that people miss



Joe Black, Dreamscope

ON YOUR PHONE OR LAPTOP

300 survey comments.

One week to tell the CEO what's really going on.

How would you do it?

Answer in one to three words.



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WHAT YOU SAID

300 comments, one week. How would you do it?

- Mine data
- Top issues
- Highlight
- Team's own words
- Secret shopper
- 360 degree reviews
- Town meetings
- Interpretive dance

WHO’S TALKING

I’m an operator, not a developer.

I take expert work and train AI to do it. Months of work becomes days.



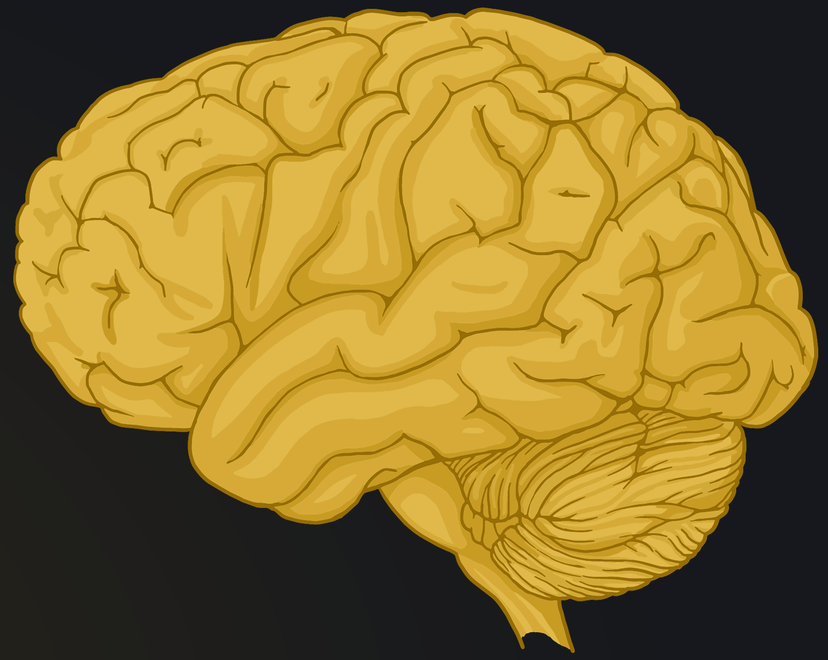
20 years
running operations and teams

10 years
in Vietnam

Shipped
a culture diagnostic and a hiring screener

Your brain can only hold a few answers at a time.

Read 20 comments and the picture is clear.



Read 300 and it only hangs onto the standouts.

THE SURVEY: EMPLOYEE NET PROMOTER SCORE

It’s the eNPS: one number and one why

THE ENPS QUESTION

0 to 10

How likely are you to recommend working here to friends and family?



THE WHY

Why?

Open text, in any language, right after the score.

A beautiful single question that surfaces what truly matters.

UNDER THE HOOD

Five steps from an answer to a decision

1

Collect

One score and one why, anonymous

→

2

Classify

AI sorts every answer against 20 factors

→

3

Check

A person checks a sample every round

→

4

Report

What people said, kept apart from our interpretation

→

5

Deliver

Walked through live, ending in dated commitments

UNDER THE HOOD

Every answer is read in the language it was written in

253
answers in Vietnamese

31
answers in English

1
report, in English, for the leaders

THE 20 DREAMSCOPE FACTORS

Every answer gets sorted against 20 factors

The system

Workspace & Tools
Processes & Role Clarity
Communication & Transparency
Fairness & Inclusion
Pay, Benefits & Security
Learning & Development

The people

Senior Leadership
My Manager
My Team & Belonging
Collaboration
Feeling Valued
Psychological Safety

The work

Autonomy
Purpose & Pride
Feedback
Workload & Pressure
Intrinsic Motivation

The person

Work-Life Balance
Energy & Health
Support Through Change

Sounds simple, right?

It took hundreds of hours of trial and error, and writing down every rule,
to get the AI to answer consistently and well.

HOW I TRAINED IT

How I taught the AI to read like me

ONCE

1. Give it a report I built by hand, plus the raw survey answers and interview transcripts.
2. Ask it to work backwards: how do you get from this to that?

THEN, OVER AND OVER

3. **Fresh chat, no context. Go.**
4. **Review the massive fuckups**
5. **Ask it why, like a person**
   Then explain my expert view.

Until it gives better answers than I do and the errors are tiny.

I started on Gemini. It runs on Claude today.

Throw your stuff at a generic AI and you get AI slop.

Teach it what good looks like and you get AI gold.

UNDER THE HOOD

What the rounds of corrections built

Definitions

One line per factor, in plain words.

Tie-break rules

Which factor wins when two could fit.

Tone rules

Complaint, praise or suggestion. No guessing a tone that isn’t there.

Permission to say “Unsure”

Guessing is worse than not knowing.

The factors come from published organizational psychology. The sorting rules are mine, refined on real answers.

UNDER THE HOOD

One answer can touch several factors

“Friendly working environment, lovely colleagues, very good benefits. There were a few changes in 2025 but on the whole they were for the entire company.”

+ My Team & Belonging **+ Pay, Benefits & Security** **~ Support Through Change**

Translated from Vietnamese · + positive · ~ mixed or neutral

“Great place to work.” → **Unsure** Too vague to place. That’s a real answer.

THE INTANGIBLES

People tell the story.
The AI names the factor.

“One-way, not two-way. You’re told once, there’s no discussing it.”

Psychological Safety

“Growing really fast… the weakness is going too fast and forgetting to keep things from the beginning.”

Purpose & Pride

“Decisions are still made according to a pyramid structure.”

Senior Leadership

TIE-BREAK RULES

When the AI wasn’t sure, I made the call. Now it’s a rule.

Recognition or information?

“Nobody says thank you.”

Feeling Valued

vs

“Nobody tells me how I’m doing.”

Feedback

One boss or the bosses?

“My boss never listens.”

My Manager

vs

“The bosses never listen.”

Senior Leadership

The rules or the trust?

“The process is rigid.”

Processes & Role Clarity

vs

“I’m not trusted to decide anything.”

Autonomy

ON YOUR PHONE OR LAPTOP · THE ENPS

Think of your current job or a past one. How likely are you to recommend working there to friends and family?

0 to 10 first, then why. Claude reads every answer while we keep going.

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WHAT YOU SAID · THE ENPS

The room's eNPS

−43	0	4	3
eNPS	Promoters (9 to 10)	Passives (7 to 8)	Detractors (0 to 6)

8 High job satisfaction. Low revenue. Boss is terrible at sales. 🤣

7 Great benefits, good team of professionals, good pay but not too much room to grow.

5 It's fine. It's not for everyone. Like a soft cheese.

3 Control > Permission

8 Past job at design firm: amazing culture, very brilliant yet humble people, tons of real world learning

7 Culture is very staid with top-down management

4 High stress but good benefits

We’ll come back to these later.

Let’s give Claude a moment to think.

ON YOUR PHONE OR LAPTOP · ONE SHORT SENTENCE

People complain about pay. What would you do?

Up to 140 characters.

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WHAT YOU SAID · PAY

People complain about pay. What do you do?

- Create a salary study and make sure that we are paying the market rates
- Explain how salaries are formulated
- Transparency
- Find ways to save them time or build a case to support their goals
- Examine bonus structure
- Understand their priorities and interests, figure out what is valuable to them (remote, pay, benefits etc)
- Get better understanding of what they want

WHAT IT FINDS · 1 OF 3

Pay complaints come with workload

11 of 20 people who mention workload also mention pay

15 of 23 people who complain about pay mention something else too, workload most often

> *“I work a lot, but the pay is low.”*
>
> Factory, scored 0, translated from Vietnamese

WHAT IT COULD MEAN

We think a raise alone may not fix it.

The action plan has no pay initiative.

From an anonymized sample report. Evidence on the left, our interpretation on the right, always kept apart.

WHAT IT MEANS · 1 OF 3

Complaints about salary are generally not about salary.

It’s “I don’t get paid enough to deal with this crap.”

Back to your eNPS results.

Let’s see what Claude found.

LIVE · YOUR ENPS, READ BY CLAUDE

Here’s what Claude found in your answers

One answer at a time: the score, the why, and the factors it touched.

WHAT CLAUDE READ · LIVE

Your answers, classified live

High job satisfaction. Low revenue. Boss is terrible at sales.	+ Intrinsic Motivation · - Pay, Benefits & Security · - My Manager
Past job at design firm: amazing culture, very brilliant yet humble people, tons of real world learning	~ Unsure ("amazing culture" too broad) · + My Team & Belonging · + Learning & Development
Great benefits, good team of professionals, good pay but not too much room to grow.	+ Pay, Benefits & Security · + My Team & Belonging · - Learning & Development
Culture is very staid with top-down management	- Senior Leadership · - Autonomy
It's fine. It's not for everyone. Like a soft cheese.	~ Unsure (too vague to place)
High stress but good benefits	- Workload & Pressure · + Pay, Benefits & Security
Control > Permission	~ Unsure (too cryptic to place)

ON YOUR PHONE OR LAPTOP · ONE SENTENCE

One region’s eNPS fell from +13 to −7 in a year.

Number 1 complaint was workload.

What do you do?

eNPS runs from −100 to +100. A 20-point drop is huge!

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WHAT YOU SAID · WORKLOAD

eNPS fell from +13 to −7. Workload is the top complaint. What do you do?

- Hire more employees
- Prioritize
- Diagnose the root cause: where are the bottlenecks and what is feasible to address?
- Understand what key changes happened at that time (group, product, process, etc)
- Make sure employees have opportunities to recharge
- Process assessment and redesign. Enlist and empower internal Rapid Transformation Tiger Teams for a 90 internal org sprint
- Review workforce and how work is divided, or how many are actually productive at any given time (PTO, LOA, etc)

WHAT IT FINDS · 2 OF 3

Six signals, two sources, one leader

THE ENPS SURVEY · 43 ANSWERS FROM THE REGION

Workload complaints at twice the company rate

eNPS fell from +13 to –7

0 people praised a manager, 5 complained

THE LEADER INTERVIEWS

Supervisors describe too much work, not enough people

One supervisor: “It’s not short headcount, it’s mentality.”

The regional leader never takes a day off and says delegation isn’t working

ONE LEADER

A regional leader who is always on

WHAT IT COULD MEAN

Her team seems to match her hours without being asked.

A coaching conversation about pace and delegation may do more than a pay raise.

WHAT IT FINDS · 3 OF 3

Your team feels growth. Leaders see no training system.

THE TEAM, IN THE SURVEY

81%

of training mentions are positive (39 of 48)

THE LEADERS, IN INTERVIEWS

65%

of leader comments on training are negative (39 of 60)

WHAT IT COULD MEAN

Colleagues train each other on the job, and it works. Leaders look for a company-wide system and don’t see one. **It’s real training. It just lives in people, not a system.**

LIVE

The real report

A quick look at a 31-page report. Every number counted by code.

Open the report →

WHAT KEEPS IT HONEST

Four rules that keep the AI honest

A person checks the AI

At least two answers per factor, plus every flagged answer, every time the survey runs.

Code does the math

Every number is counted by code. The AI never does the math.

Evidence kept apart

Quotes and counts in one place. Our interpretation sits under “What it could mean.”

Safety first

A safety concern reaches the client within 24 hours after the survey closes, and is never quoted.

The AI guides.

A person decides.

ON YOUR PHONE OR LAPTOP

Questions

Type yours. They come up in the order they arrive.

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YOUR QUESTIONS

Q&A

- Human in the loop. How did you map where human judgment was most important or definitely needed? Answered live
- Curious about accommodating (or enlisting) "Thinking Fast, Thinking Slow" modes of reflection. Fast = input as fast a blink for immediate gut feel. Answered live
- Now that you've built the model, how much customization does every new client require (roughly), like 80/20? Answered live
- How do you overcome doubts about anonymity and encourage employees to be open and honest?
- How do you "sell" this to potential clients? Do you have established clients that do this every X months?
- Do you do follow up work?
- How transparent is your system as far as traceability for decisions re: how employee feedback is interpreted / classified?

What did you get out of this, and what will you try?

We’ll go around. One minute each.

ON YOUR PHONE OR LAPTOP · I'M ALWAYS TRYING TO IMPROVE

Help me make the next cohort session better

I like…

One thing to keep.

I wish…

One thing to change.



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Dreamscope

Thank you

Everything works better if people love what they do.

Scan for my card

joe@dreamscope.win
linkedin.com/in/joevblack

BONUS

How long all of this took

ME

4 hours

Ideas, decisions, edits and two run-throughs.

CLAUDE

11.5 hours

The slides, the phone pages, the live word clouds, the live Q&A and the live read of your eNPS.

Rounded, from our chat logs, 27 Oct to 1 Nov. Claude often ran several jobs at once.